Caryse Chang

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Education

Occidental College Expected May 2030

- Bachelor of Arts, Biology; Public Health and Philosophy Minor

Campolindo High School May 2026

- 13 APs, 4.65 weighted GPA, 4.0 unweighted GPA

Relevant Experience

John Muir Health June 2024 – August 2026

Student Supervisor June 2025 – August 2026

- Co-lead a 12-person volunteer shift in a high-volume clinic, delegating tasks and ensuring compliance with hospital policies and department coordination
- Serve as primary liaison between clinical staff and the volunteer team, directing services to highest-priority units while advocating for volunteer needs
- Organize team-bonding activities to strengthen shift culture and improve volunteer retention rate

General Volunteer August 2024 – August 2025

- Transport lab samples, patient discharges, organize and stock department supplies, write patient schedules in PT department, transport medical equipment and other supplies
- Utilized interpersonal skills & empathy to comfort & talk to patients, deliver food trays & gifts, discharge

miRcore

Member and Group Leader June 2024 – August 2026

- Led a computational biology research team studying the genetic causes of Alzheimer's Disease; research resulted in publication in the miRcore Science Journal
- Advocated for public scientific awareness by raising $10,700 for frontotemporal dementia research, co-running middle school biology workshops with ~500 students, and designing pamphlets promoting vaccination and science literacy
- Mentored 6 freshmen in miRcore's Computational Biology summer camp through original research on Parkinson's Disease

BioEngineering High School Competition (BioEHSC), UC Berkeley February 2022 – April 2025

Seasonal Research Team Captain February 2025 – April 2025

- Directed a 5-student team through an intensive 7-week bioengineering competition, overseeing the project from problem identification through symposium presentation
- Set weekly research goals, ensured team alignment on progress, and mentored teammates in academic literature review and data synthesis

Researcher February 2022 – April 2024

- Developed novel solutions to prevalent bioengineering problems; our projects were on treatment of multi-drug resistant tuberculosis, earlier AD diagnosis, and retinitis pigmentosa treatment
- Presented solutions to industry investors and researchers in academia at an all-day conference

Additional Experience

Lamorinda Summer Music Camp

Seasonal Principal Cello Coach Camp Counselor June 2023 – June 2026

- Taught group lessons, ensemble coaching, and provided performance opportunities for young musicians' at a summer

music camp for local elementary and middle school musicians, reaching 50+ students each summer
- Planned camp activities, organized outreach, and ensured students enjoyed the music experience
- Taught cello, bass, and viola students music technique and theory, and coached chamber groups for a cumulative performance for the Lamorinda community

Note by Note, Campolindo High School
Founder and President August 2024 – May 2026
- Founded a community non-profit pairing high school musicians with elementary and middle school students for affordable music instruction
- Grew student enrollment to 125 students in 4 neighboring towns through community outreach, school partnerships, school presentations, and social media
- Manage mentor-student pairings and club funds; trained 50 high school mentors; iterated program structure based on parent and mentor feedback to maintain lesson quality

Orchestra, Campolindo High School & Acalanes High School District August 2022 – May 2026
Section Leader August 2024 – May 2026
- Lead cello section of 11 members through weekly sectionals, alternating between full-group instruction and targeted one-on-one coaching to address varying experience levels
- Organized and led 23 cellists as cello section leader of the district orchestra during the music program's trip to SoCal
- Advocate as student liaison, representing the section's logistical and musical concerns to the director
- Foster inclusive section culture by organizing and planning social events

Section cellist August 2022 – May 2024
- Taught younger students and helped foster community through helping previous section leaders plan events while playing as the fourth and third chair cellist

Symphony of Service
Chamber Group Performer June 2022 – July 2025
- Organize and perform with a chamber group of 4 string players, selecting repertoire tailored to each audience
- Performed for 4 senior homes (approximately 35 seniors each) and 2 middle schools over 4 years

PROJECTS

Alzheimer's Disease Research 2025 – 2026 Researcher August 2024 – Present
Lead Author
- Conducting research on Alzheimer's Disease using computational tools to analyze differences in gene expression that may contribute to Alzheimer's pathology
- Publication forthcoming (2025-2026)

Global Life Expectancy and Healthcare Spending February 2026 – April 2026
Data Science Researcher
- Completed a 7-week data science program, developing Python skills and applying data analysis libraries to an independent research project
- Analyzed the correlation between a country's GDP expenditure on healthcare and average citizen life expectancy

Type 1 Diabetes Research Paper May 2025 – July 2025
Independent Author
- Independently authored a computational bioinformatics study on the genetic cause of Type 1 Diabetes
- Published in Nexus Research Journal, an international high school research journal, as 1 of 2 accepted papers
- Identified upregulation of genes in the IL-17 signaling pathway as a driver of pancreatic inflammation and beta cell destruction

Health and Happiness Research April 2025 – June 2025

Independent Author

• Authored independent research paper published in UpNextScientists Research Journal (2025)

• Studied how happiness and health condition correlated by statistically analyzing data collected globally from a survey

SKILLS

• Advocacy: Community Outreach, Science Communication, Program Development, Fundraising

• Laboratory Techniques: Micropipetting, Gel Electrophoresis, PCR, DNA Extraction and Analysis, Centrifugation, Bacterial Culture and Transformation

• Technical: Python, Data Analysis, Bioinformatics Tools

CERTIFICATIONS

• **CNA Certification**, California Public Health Department (Exp. 01/2028)

  • Studied 100 hours of theory and 100 hours of clinicals at Chaparral House in Berkeley, CA

• **BLS Certification**, American Heart Association (Exp. 10/2028)

  • successfully completed the cognitive and skills evaluations in accordance with the curriculum of the American Heart Association Basic Life Support (CPR and AED) Program

• **Biotechnology ROP**, Contra Costa County ROP (rec. 2025): Completed biotechnology coursework through CCC ROP, gaining hands-on laboratory skills including micropipetting, gel electrophoresis, centrifugation, PCR, DNA extraction and analysis, and bacterial culture and plasmid transformation.

AWARDS & HONORS

• **John Muir Health Auxiliary Scholarship** (2026): One of nine seniors selected for this scholarship recognizing commitment to community service, passion for healthcare, and overall accomplishments.

• **Gold Presidential Volunteer Service Award** (2025): Earned the highest level of the Presidential national service award for 250+ hours of community service across senior homes, hospital volunteering, miRcore advocacy, and middle school biology workshops.

• **BioOlympiad Honorable Mention**, USA Biology Olympiad (2024): Scored in the top 20% of all test-takers nationwide on the US Biology Olympiad exam.